

Unit 1.3 Vocabulary

Program Design & Development · Study Sheet



Know These Cold

Every word here can appear on the AP exam, and the documentation and credit rules apply to your Create task. Fold the sheet and quiz yourself!

Development process

Investigate, design, prototype, test. Can be ordered and intentional, or exploratory.

e.g., Survey users → sketch screens → build → test

Investigation

Finding out what users need through surveys, interviews, user testing, and direct observation.

e.g., Interviewing the librarian before building a checkout app

Program requirements

Describe how a program **functions**; may include descriptions of user interactions.

e.g., "Users must be able to search by category"

Program specification

Defines the **requirements** for a program.

e.g., A document listing everything the app must do

Storyboard

A sketch of each screen in order, showing what the user sees and does.

e.g., Paper drawings of the login, menu, and cart screens

Module

A separate part of a program that handles one job.

e.g., A login module and a payment module

Prototype

An early, working model of a program used to test ideas.

e.g., A clickable version where only the main button works

Iterative development

Refinement and revision based on feedback, testing, or reflection.

e.g., Redesigning a confusing menu after user testing

Incremental development

Build in **smaller pieces**; each works before it's added to the whole.

e.g., Building and testing level 1 before level 2

Program documentation

Describes the function of code and how it was developed; helps **maintain** programs.

e.g., A README explaining each procedure

Comments

Documentation written **in the program** that is not executed.

e.g., `# calculates the average score`

Acknowledgment

Naming the source or original author of any code you didn't write.

e.g., `# sort procedure from J. Kim's tutorial`

Don't Mix These Up!

- **Iterative vs. Incremental:** iterative = revise what exists using feedback; incremental = add a new working piece.
- **Requirements vs. Specification:** requirements describe what the program must do; the specification is where they're defined.
- **Comments vs. Documentation:** comments are one kind of documentation, written inside the code.



Exam tip:

Using someone else's code is allowed — but you must give credit. Renaming variables never makes copied code yours.